

S. Andrew Lanham

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SUMMARY

I work out what a technology does and how that matches its claims in an explainable manner. I spent 9 years evaluating emerging quantum and analog computing systems against vendor claims; I have done consulting work on technical documentation and system design for engineering teams; and most recently served as engineering lead on a commercial hardware product now in the field. The work I am interested in goes by many names – applications engineering, applied research, test and benchmarking, systems and technical program roles. Austin or remote preferred.

SKILLS

- **Embedded:** PIC32, STM32F4, C, I2C, SPI, UART, real-time digital I/O, DAC control
- **Hardware:** PCB design, sensor design, mechanical prototyping, evaluation boards, supplier and manufacturing coordination
- **Software:** Python, MATLAB, C
- **Signal Processing:** space-time block coding, detection strategies, noise modeling, Gaussian statistics, Bayesian inference
- **Quantum:** quantum error correction, quantum emulation, resource-state simulation, quantum-inspired algorithms, benchmarking against quantum devices
- **Specification and Documentation:** technical specifications, interface definition, requirements documentation, stakeholder validation, Microsoft Word, Microsoft Excel

EDUCATION

The University of Texas at Austin, Austin, TX

Master of Science, Electrical Engineering, August 2019

- Thesis: Quantum Information Processing Approaches in Classical Systems (Advisors: Robert W. Heath Jr., Brian La Cour)

Bachelor of Science, Electrical Engineering, May 2017

EXPERIENCE

Engineering Lead and Hardware Design

Austin, TX

Sky High Cold Brew

January 2025 - Present

Replaced a keg-based product line, which relied on nitrogen tanks and pressure-fed tubing, with a post-mix generation: concentrate brewed and mixed at the point of dispense in a smaller enclosure. Minimum viable building size dropped from 250+ units to 50+, and the smaller system also fits commercial sites that are not measured in units at all. Addressable market roughly 10x larger, at under 50% of the original BOM cost. First units are in the field and the design is production-ready.

- **Hardware Engineering:** PCB and embedded design, prototyping and deployment; pump, valve and mixing chamber integration; mechanical prototyping
- **Supply Chain:** sourced and qualified suppliers and set up the manufacturing chain behind the new line

Engineering Scientist

Applied Research Laboratories, UT Austin

Center for Quantum Research

August 2019 - January 2025

Led research and development at the intersection of quantum information science, advanced signal processing, and hardware systems. My work included architecting novel algorithms and benchmarking analog and digital computing systems against quantum devices.

- **Statistical Modeling:** Quantum-classical boundary, Gaussian statistics and post-selection. Simulation and analysis software development in Python
- **Statistical Modeling:** Benchmarking analog computing systems. Modeling noise, detection strategies. MATLAB, Python, and C/C++ software library design for signal processing and statistical benchmarking
- **Wireless Communication and Signal Processing:** New algorithms for wireless communication in the area of space-time block coding. Algorithm design and validation in MATLAB, Python

- **Embedded Implementation:** Embedded system and PCB design using the STM32F4 family

Engineer, Systems Architecture

Tacen, Inc.

November 2017 - January 2019

Authored the formal technical documentation and system specifications for a high-performance, non-custodial digital asset exchange by communicating with project engineers. I was responsible for mathematically modeling and documenting the core logic to guide external engineering and stakeholder validation.

- **System Design and Documentation:** Authored end-to-end technical spec for a decentralized exchange backend and asset custody system
- **System Design and Documentation:** Interfaced with engineering teams to define and document modular interfaces for DEX backend components

Graduate Research Assistant

Center for Quantum Research

Applied Research Laboratories, UT Austin

May 2017 - August 2019

Pioneered the experimental application of quantum error correction (QEC) to classical analog computing systems

Firmware Engineer and Product Design

Bad Hair Modular

November 2016 - September 2017

Designed and implemented the complete embedded firmware for a multi-channel digital/analog modular synthesizer module using a PIC32 microcontroller. My responsibilities included architecting the multi-mode user interface, managing real-time digital I/O, and controlling the I2C DAC for the analog output stages.

- **Embedded Design:** Designed PIC32-based firmware controlling a modular synthesizer's multi-mode envelope generation

ROLES AND MENTORSHIP

- **Technical Communication and Global Presentations:** Delivered talks and project presentations at international conferences and showcases
- **University Tutor and Research Mentor:** Tutored advanced technical subjects and mentored students on theses and internships
- **Science Communication:** Founded and produce *Quantum Computing Review*, a YouTube channel reviewing quantum optics literature for a general audience; AI-assisted research and graphic design

PATENTS

"Space-time encoding in wireless communication systems." U.S. Patent No. 11,218,195. 4 Jan. 2022.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Nandyala, Mahesh and **S.A. Lanham** and Jha, Prashant K. and Wu, Chengyue and Hazle, John D. and Yankeelov, Thomas E. and Stafford, R. Jason and El-Gendy, Ahmed A. and Fuentes, David, "An Information-Theoretic Framework for Optimal Experimental Design in Magnetic Nanoparticle Hyperthermia." *Applied Mathematical Modelling*. To appear.

T.C. Cuvelier, **S.A. Lanham**, B.R. La Cour, and R.W. Heath Jr. "Quantum Codes for Classical Communication: A Space-Time Block Code from Quantum Error Correction." *IEEE Open Journal of the Communications Society*. October 2021.

S. Xie, M. Yang, **S.A. Lanham**, M. Wang, Y. Wang, S. Oruganti, J.R. Kulkarni. "Snap-SAT: A One-Shot Energy-Performance-Aware All-Digital Compute-in-Memory Solver for Large-Scale Hard Boolean Satisfiability Problems." *2023 IEEE International Solid-State Circuits Conference (ISSCC)*. IEEE 2023.

S.A. Lanham, E. Bradley, and B.R. La Cour. "Generalized Noncoherent Space-Time Block Codes from Quantum Error Correction." *2022 IEEE Military Communications Conference (MILCOM)*. IEEE 2022.

S.A. Lanham, and Brian R. La Cour. “Quantum Resource States from Post-Selected Classical Mixed States.” *2024 IEEE International Conference on Quantum Computing and Engineering (QCE)*. Vol. 1. IEEE 2024.

ADDITIONAL PUBLICATIONS

C. Ostrove, B.R. La Cour, **S.A. Lanham**, and Granville Ott. “Improving Performance of an Analog Electronic Device Using Quantum Error Correction.” *Journal of Physics Communications*. 2019.

S.A. Lanham, and Brian R. La Cour. “Bell State Statistics with Post-Selection Loophole.” *Quantum 2.0*. Optica Publishing Group, 2024.

S.A. Lanham, and B.R. La Cour. “A Quantum-Inspired Classical Solver for Boolean k -Satisfiability Problems.” *2021 IEEE International Conference on Quantum Computing and Engineering (QCE)*. IEEE 2021.

S.A. Lanham, and B.R. La Cour. “Detection-Based Measurements for Quantum Emulation Devices.” *2020 IEEE International Conference on Quantum Computing and Engineering (QCE)*. IEEE 2020.

S.A. Lanham, T.C. Cuvelier, C. Ostrove, B.R. La Cour, G. Ott and R.W. Heath Jr. “A Non-coherent Space-Time Code from Quantum Error Correction.” *2019 53rd Annual Conference on Information Sciences and Systems (CISS)*, Baltimore, MD, March 2019, pp. 1-6.

B.R. La Cour, **S.A. Lanham** and C. Ostrove. “Parallel Quantum Computing Emulation.” *2018 IEEE International Conference on Rebooting Computing (ICRC)*, McLean, VA, 2018, pp. 1-9.

B.R. La Cour, G.E. Ott, and **S.A. Lanham**. “Using Quantum Emulation for Advanced Computation.” *2017 IEEE Custom Integrated Circuits Conference (CICC)*, Austin, TX, 2017.

(*archival*) Lanham, S. Andrew. “Quantum-Inspired Approximations to Constraint Satisfaction Problems.” arXiv preprint arXiv:2212.04016 (2022).